



Material theme on Calendar

Google's brand new Material Theme has made its way to Google Calendar on the web, the mobile app will follow in a few months. <https://dgit.in/jan19-20>



Samsung's Bright Night

Samsung could be working on their own version of Night Mode found in Pixel devices called 'Bright Night'. <https://dgit.in/jan19-20>

Samsung AX5500

A robust performer

Samsung launched its AX5500 air purifier in October, right around the time when air pollution levels were rising across India. With its new device, the company has made sure that all necessary requirements are met to filter out the harmful particulates in the air and it is also equipped with a carbon filter to eliminate harmful gases. We tested it out.

Build and Design

The Samsung AX5500 looks almost like a semi-tower fan that might not blend in with the decor of your home. The device's body is constructed out of durable ABS plastic. Samsung has fit wheels on the device as well, making it easier to move the 11.6kg device to different areas in your home.

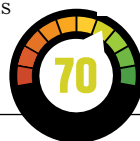
The air purifier's air inlet on the front and the entire magnetically attached front panel can be removed easily to reveal the filters placed inside. The one on the top pushes out the maximum amount of clean air, while the two side outlets are relatively smaller. The design is similar to what we have seen in a majority of air purifiers with some minor tweaks that add functionality.

Filters

A combined filter can be as efficient as two standard separate filters and it also proves to be less of a hassle when it's time to get a replacement. Additionally, in its combined filter, Samsung choose to place the carbon filter before the HEPA filter, which is a smart decision as the carbon filter lasts much longer in comparison to a particle filter. We used the air purifier continuously for around a week, after which the pre-filter was chock full of dust, hair and pet dander. This is a good sign that the pre-filter is working



Price
₹33,490



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as intended and prolonging the overall life of subsequent filters.

Replacement filters cost Rs 4,990 but this seems to be a fair price considering that the device's filters last for more than 8500 hours in average conditions.

Performance

In room 1, before commencing our first standard 45 minute run of the air purifier, the PM2.5 and PM10 levels were 519 and 623 $\mu\text{g}/\text{m}^3$ respectively. Running the air purifier on max speed setting for 45 minutes brought down the PM2.5 levels to 59 and PM10 to 64. It showed a similar level of performance for room 2 and 3 as well, bringing down PM2.5 and PM10 levels significantly during our tests. It's safe to say that the device is a commendable performer. It makes good use of the three-way airflow system and is capable of bettering air quality even on days when the air pollution is severely high.

Controls

The device does not come with any sort of IoT features or even app compatibility, which leaves much to

be desired. The controls to use the air purifier are right on top of the device. It features touch-enabled buttons for turning the device on and off, Fan Speed control, Sleep Mode, Speed Mode, Enable/Disable Virus Doctor, Timer and Lock. Once the fan speed is put on auto mode, the device makes use of the PM2.5 and VOC sensor to detect the level of particulates and harmful gases in the air respectively and adjust the fan speed accordingly.

With the company's S-Plasma Ioniser technology (SPI), the Virus Doctor feature is said to eliminate bacteria, fungi, mould and other allergens from the air using charged ions. There is no way for us to test the claims the company makes of their device eliminating "up to 99% of certain viruses and bacteria."

There is also a digital display that shows PM2.5 levels in $\mu\text{g}/\text{m}^3$ and indicates the level of gaseous contaminants with four different colour variations. The display is sufficiently bright and we had no problems in getting an idea of what the PM2.5 levels inside the room were. One can also get a gist of the air quality with a tree symbol that is displayed alongside the PM2.5 reading on the display. The symbol features four colour variations, Blue, Green, Yellow and Red, on the top panel.

Bottomline

The device is well designed and performs consistently in areas with varying levels of air pollution and is definitely best suited for areas with high pollution levels like Delhi, Faridabad, Hyderabad and others. In case you want a device that is similarly efficient and offers IoT smarts, you can go for the Blueair Classic 280i. There is also the Kent Alps air purifier which is a good budget option.

—Shubham Sharma

SPECIFICATIONS

CAPACITY (m^2): 60 m^2 | NOISE (DBA): 50 dBA | NET DIMENSION: 360 x 783 x 293 mm | NET WEIGHT(KG): 11.6 kg | OPERATING MODE: Auto | POWER CONSUMPTION(W): 60 W

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